members shared a commonality of interests with these other actors and were part of the complex insurgency there.

According to a senior US defense official, the militants Lashkar deployed to Eastern Afghanistan were, along with militants from JeM, among the most effective fighters in the region.[101] An ISAF official said that when there was a particularly well-organized attack Lashkar was their default suspect since 'they are top notch fighters, a cut above what we normally see.'[102] An attack on US Combat Outpost (COP) Wanat in mid-July 2008 is among the most notable operations in which Lashkar cadres are known to have participated since entering the Afghan theater. They were part of a force consisting of almost 200 militants from several different outfits who assaulted and nearly overran the combat outpost, which was located in the village of Wanat in Nuristan near the border with neighboring Kunar province. Nine US soldiers were killed and another fifteen US soldiers and four Afghan soldiers were wounded during four hours of fighting.[103] The insurgents were advanced enough to warn the villagers to leave beforehand, gather undetected and mount the operation without breaking radio silence, which would have alerted the allied force.[104]

Six days earlier, on 7 July 2008, Hamza Shakoor drove an explosives-laden vehicle into the Indian embassy in Kabul. The Haqqani Network planned the operation, but Shakoor had entered the world of militancy when JuD's Gujranwala chapter recruited him in 2006.[105] The attack reportedly was supposed to be a fidayeen assault, but the embassy had upgraded its security after the Riyasat-e-Amniyate-Milli [Afghanistan's security service, known as RAM] alerted India. This made such an attack more operationally challenging, which presumably led Shakoor to execute the vehicle-born suicide bombing operation.[106] American officials later accused the ISI of helping to plan the attack.[107] This was not an isolated incident. According to US intelligence, the ISI used the Haqqani Network to strike Indian targets in Afghanistan on other occasions.[108] In addition to attacking Indian targets, Haqqani militants were also responsible for a host of assaults against high-profile coalition targets. It is unclear whether Shakoor was dispatched to take part in the operation against the Indian embassy, volunteered for the assignment or was already fighting alongside the Haqqanis by this time. It is also worth highlighting that collaboration